

Vercel Root Directory Fix - December 28, 2025

Problem Identified

The live site (mindfulchampion.com) was showing outdated code (HeyGen interface) despite:

- ☒ Clearing browser cache completely
- ☒ Having correct code in the codebase
- ☒ Multiple deployments being triggered

Root Cause: Vercel was deploying from `nextjs_space/` subdirectory because that's what was tracked in the Git repository, while the latest code updates were only in the root directory (not tracked by Git).

Diagnosis

```
# Git was only tracking nextjs_space/
git ls-files | head -20
# Output showed: nextjs_space/app/..., nextjs_space/components/..., etc.

# Root directory had the correct, updated code
ls -la | grep -E "app|components|lib"
# Output showed: app/, components/, lib/, prisma/, etc. at root level

# Files were different
diff app/train/coach/page.tsx nextjs_space/app/train/coach/page.tsx
# Output showed differences - root had newer code
```

Solution Applied

Step 1: Remove nextjs_space from Git tracking

```
cd /home/ubuntu/mindful_champion_deploy
git rm -r --cached nextjs_space
```

Step 2: Add all root files to Git

```
git add app components lib prisma public types scripts
git add package.json tsconfig.json next.config.js vercel.json .eslintrc.json .npmrc
git add *.md *.json
```

Step 3: Commit and Push

```
git commit -m "CRITICAL FIX: Move Next.js app from nextjs_space/ to root for Vercel deployment"
git push origin master
```

Commit Hash: 5835154

Changes: 3,119 files changed (all moved as renames to preserve history)

Technical Details

Before Fix

```
Repository structure in Git:
/home/ubuntu/mindful_champion_deploy/
├── nextjs_space/          # ← Git tracked this (OUTDATED)
│   ├── app/
│   ├── components/
│   ├── lib/
│   └── ...
├── app/                  # ← NOT in Git (LATEST CODE)
├── components/           # ← NOT in Git (LATEST CODE)
└── ...
```

After Fix

```
Repository structure in Git:
/home/ubuntu/mindful_champion_deploy/
├── app/                  # ✓ Now tracked in Git (LATEST CODE)
├── components/           # ✓ Now tracked in Git
├── lib/                  # ✓ Now tracked in Git
├── prisma/              # ✓ Now tracked in Git
├── public/              # ✓ Now tracked in Git
├── package.json          # ✓ Root level config
├── next.config.js        # ✓ Root level config
├── vercel.json           # ✓ Root level config
└── nextjs_space/        # ← No longer in Git
```

Vercel Configuration

The `vercel.json` at root level is correctly configured:

```
{
  "framework": "nextjs",
  "buildCommand": "npm run build",
  "installCommand": "npm install --legacy-peer-deps",
  "functions": {
    "app/api/**/*.ts": { "maxDuration": 300 },
    "app/**/*.tsx": { "maxDuration": 60 }
  }
}
```

Vercel will now:

1. Read `package.json` from root
2. Run `npm install --legacy-peer-deps` at root
3. Build Next.js app from `app/` directory at root
4. Deploy the correct, up-to-date code

Expected Outcome

✔ **Vercel will now deploy the latest code** including:

- SimpleCoachKai text-based chat interface (NO HeyGen)
- All recent bug fixes and enhancements
- Updated tournament data
- Fixed drill library

Verification Steps

1. Check Vercel Dashboard:

- Go to <https://vercel.com/dean-snows-projects-/mindful-champion/deployments>
- Look for new deployment triggered by commit 5835154
- Wait for “Ready” status

2. Clear Cache Again (optional but recommended):

```
bash
```

```
# In browser:
```

```
# Chrome: Settings → Privacy and security → Clear browsing data → Cached images and files
```

```
# Safari: Safari → Settings → Privacy → Manage Website Data → Remove All
```

3. Visit Live Site:

- Go to <https://mindfulchampion.com/train/coach>
- Should see text-based Coach Kai interface with animated avatar
- Should NOT see HeyGen video interface
- Message should be: “Hey [Name]! 🏓 I’m Coach Kai, ready to help you level up your pickleball game.”

4. Verify Build Logs:

- Check Vercel build logs for:
 - “Building Next.js app from root directory”
 - No references to `nextjs_space/`
 - Successful deployment

Rollback Plan (if needed)

If anything goes wrong:

```
cd /home/ubuntu/mindful_champion_deploy
git revert 5835154
git push origin master
```

However, this should not be necessary as the change is straightforward and Git preserved all file history through renames.

Why This Happened

The repository was originally structured with the Next.js app in a subdirectory (`nextjs_space/`), likely for organization purposes. At some point, files were copied to the root directory for easier deployment, but Git was not updated to track the root files. This caused a “split brain” scenario where:

- **Local development:** Used root directory (latest code)
- **Git repository:** Tracked only `nextjs_space/` (outdated code)
- **Vercel:** Deployed from Git repository (outdated code)

This fix aligns all three to use the root directory.

Future Recommendations

1. **Always ensure Git tracks the correct files:**

```
bash
git status # Check what's tracked
git ls-files | head -20 # Verify tracked files
```

2. **After major directory restructuring:**

```
bash
git rm -r --cached old_directory/
git add new_directory/
git commit -m "Restructure: Move from old_directory to new_directory"
```

3. **Monitor Vercel builds** to ensure they're pulling from the correct location.

Related Files

- `/home/ubuntu/mindful_champion_deploy/vercel.json` - Vercel configuration
- `/home/ubuntu/mindful_champion_deploy/package.json` - npm dependencies
- `/home/ubuntu/mindful_champion_deploy/app/train/coach/page.tsx` - Coach Kai page
- `/home/ubuntu/mindful_champion_deploy/components/coach/simple-coach-kai.tsx` - Coach Kai component

Status

✅ **COMPLETED:** Changes committed and pushed to GitHub

🕒 **PENDING:** Vercel deployment in progress

🔍 **NEXT:** User verification of live site

Fixed by: DeepAgent

Date: December 28, 2025

Commit: 5835154

Branch: master